Science Lights The Lamp : CHASCON 2025



The 18th Chandigarh Science Congress (CHASCON-2025) was held at Panjab University, Chandigarh from November 6 to 8, 2025. With the theme "Empowering Humanity: Science, Technology, and Healthcare for All" the conference brought together policymakers, experienced faculty, research scholars, and students from across disciplines and departments to share ideas, present their work, and celebrate the spirit of science. Guided by the leadership of Chief Patron Prof. Renu Vig, Vice Chancellor of Panjab University, and coordinated by Dr. Kashmir Singh along with co-coordinators Dr. Naveen Gupta and Dr. Deepak Kumar Gupta, the event was marked by warmth, enthusiasm, and a strong sense of community. Our department hosted the MATHEMATICAL SCIENCES section, where Dr. Anuj Sharma served as the Sectional President, and Dr. Rohini Sharma served as the Sectional Secretary.

The first day of CHASCON-2025, November 6, 2025, began at the Law Auditorium of Panjab University with the registration of participants, setting the stage for three days of scientific exchange and celebration. The keynote address that followed gave direction and energy to the event, inspiring the audience and establishing the theme of empowering humanity through science, technology, and healthcare. After a short tea break, the first scientific session started at 11:30 a.m., where scholars presented their research and engaged in meaningful discussions. Running alongside these sessions was the CHASCON Expo, held from 11:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., where students and researchers displayed their creative works of art, innovative ideas, and research projects. The Expo added a vibrant dimension to the day, making the atmosphere lively and interactive.

The second day of CHASCON-2025 , November 7, 2025 , unfolded across the departmental venues, beginning with Scientific Session III at 9:30 a.m. For the UG poster presentations held at the RUSA Lab, the judging panel included Prof. (Dr.) Anu Gupta from the Department of Computer Science & Applications and Dr. Kulbhushan Agnihotri from the Department of Mathematics. This was followed by poster presentations by Ph.D. scholars at 10:30 a.m., where the first prize was awarded to Mr. Manit Malhotra from the Department of Computer Science (DCSA), and the second prize went to Mr. Karan Pathania, also from DCSA. After a short tea break, the focus shifted to poster presentations by UG and PG students, which saw enthusiastic participation and lively exchanges. In this category, the first prize was secured by Shivnandan from the Department of Statistics. The oral presentations showcased the creativity and confidence of young scholars, with Harmanjot and Hardik from Statistics Department winning first prize, Akriti Thakur and Sachin Kumar from DCSA taking second place, and Akshita along with Himani Sharma from Statistics department earning third. The day concluded on a warm note with high tea and networking, leaving participants inspired and energized for the final day of the conference.



The final day of CHASCON-2025 , November 8 , 2025 , returned to the Law Auditorium and opened with the CHASCON-CRIKC Shodh Samwad. This special session invited young scientists, research scholars, and post-doctoral fellows to share the story of their research journeys, whether at the stage of a validated proof of concept, incubation, prototype development, or transformation into a product or project with potential outcomes for public welfare. After a short tea break, Scientific Session IV was conducted at 11:00 a.m., adding further depth to the discussions. The day then moved into the closing valedictory function, which celebrated the achievements of participants and acknowledged the tireless efforts of the organizers. Awards were presented to outstanding contributors. The event concluded with a lunch, leaving participants with a sense of accomplishment, inspiration, and shared purpose.

CHASCON-2025 was more than just a conference—it was a celebration of knowledge, collaboration, and innovation. Over three days, it created a space where science was not only discussed but lived, with participants leaving inspired and motivated. The event highlighted Panjab University's commitment to fostering research and empowering humanity through science and technology, leaving behind memories of learning, camaraderie, and shared purpose.

– Girija Sharma MCA–I(M)

Freshers and Farewell (Aagaaz 2025)





The DCSA Freshers' and Farewell celebration lit up the Law auditorium on November 13, 2025 with unforgettable energy, color, and talent. The day brimmed with fun, laughter, and a vibrant mix of performances by both first-year and final-year students. The event was seamlessly coordinated by Dr. Jasleen Kaur Bains and Dr. Balwinder Kaur and graced by the presence of Chairperson Dr. Anuj Sharma along with faculty members Prof. (Dr.) Sonal Chawla , Prof. (Dr.) Anu Gupta , Dr. Rohini Sharma , Dr. Anuj Kumar , Dr. Supreet Thapar and Dr. Kavita Taneja.

The ceremony commenced with the lighting of the lamp and the Panjab University Anthem, followed by an inspiring address by the Chairperson - Dr. Anuj Sharma , motivating students to pursue their academic and creative paths with enthusiasm. The cultural segment electrified the auditorium with lively Bollywood performances by M.Sc. Computer Science (Specialization in Data Science) First Year, MCA (Morning) First Year, and the Cultural Team, along with colourful folk dances including Haryanvi, Himachali Naati, and a thunderous Bhangra.





Aditi's soulful singing, Abhishek's energetic vocals, and Dilshan's powerful song together lifted the entire audience and set a lively tone for the celebration. Mehak's heartfelt poem about the memorable two-year journey added an emotional touch to the event. One of the highlights of the day was the ramp walk, where both Freshers and Final Year students captivated the audience with great confidence and stage presence.







Among the Freshers, Sanjam (MSc-I) and Rigzin (MCA-I (E)) were crowned Ms. and Mr. Fresher. Ridhi (MCA-I (M)) and Rishabh (MSc-I) received the titles of Ms. and Mr. Personality, while Sneha (MSc-I) and Shivam (MSc-I) were awarded Ms. and Mr. Well Dressed. The Ms. and Mr. Confident titles went to Aditi (MCA-I (E)) and Satvik (MSc-I).

From the Final Year batch, Twinkle (MCA-II (M)) and Sahil (MCA-II (M)) won Ms. and Mr. Farewell, Aditi (MSc-II) and Jai (MSc-II) were honoured as Ms. and Mr. Well Dressed, Shriya (MCA-II (E)) and Pulkit (MCA-II (E)) received the Ms. and Mr. Confident titles, while Harkirat (MCA-II (E)) and Manmeet (MCA-II (E)) were named Ms. and Mr. Personality. In addition, Ishneet Kaur (MCA-II (M)) and Nayan (MSc-II) were recognised as Ms. and Mr. Performer for their outstanding contributions in making the event a grand success.



A delicious lunch feast, offering a variety of well-prepared dishes, along with the visual grandeur of the event, added immensely to its charm and further enhanced the overall experience for everyone present. The entire auditorium was beautifully decorated under the meticulous leadership of Ishneet Kaur, Head of the Decorations Team of the Cultural Committee. The elegant and vibrant decor was the result of dedicated collaborative efforts by a team of enthusiastic student volunteers and Cultural Committee members, whose creativity and hard work transformed the venue into a lively and welcoming space, perfectly complementing the spirit of the celebration.

The celebration concluded with heartfelt words from Cultural Club coordinators Dr. Jasleen Kaur and Dr. Balwinder Kaur, followed by a warm vote of thanks from student coordinators Sahil and Jai, bringing the joyous event to a memorable close.

— Rishabh Bhatia MSC-I

Building Brighter Futures Through Curriculum Change





The Curriculum Revision Workshop titled "Introduction of Advanced Courses at Undergraduate Level in Panjab University Affiliated Colleges" was successfully conducted at Panjab University, Chandigarh, on 14th November, and was organized by the Department of Computer Science & Applications (DCSA), Panjab University. The main purpose of this workshop was to hold meaningful academic discussions and planning for the introduction of new and in-demand undergraduate courses such as B.Sc. Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning, B.Sc. Data Science, and B.Sc. Cyber Security in the affiliated colleges of Panjab University. The session was coordinated under the leadership of the workshop Coordinator Prof. (Dr.) Sonal Chawla along with Chairperson of DCSA, Dr. Anuj Sharma, at Rajiv Gandhi College Bhawan, Panjab University, Chandigarh.

The day began with great enthusiasm as faculty members from different colleges arrived at the venue. The workshop commenced sharply at 9:00 AM with the registration process, which was conducted smoothly through both online and offline modes. The workshop had over 100 registered participants. After registering, participants marked their attendance, collected their welcome kits, and proceeded to breakfast. The breakfast session also became a pleasant opportunity for informal interaction, where participants connected with one another, shared experiences, and discussed their expectations from the workshop.

The Inaugural Session began sharply at 10:00 AM, setting a formal yet warm tone for the day. The workshop was honoured by the presence of our distinguished chief guests, namely Prof. Yojna Rawat, Dean University Instructions (DUI), Panjab University, and Prof. (Dr.) Meenakshi Goyal, Director, Research and Development Cell, Panjab University. Dr. Anuj Sharma and Prof. Sonal Chawla formally welcomed the chief guests and presented them with mementos as a mark of respect and gratitude. A key moment of the inauguration was the Lamp Lighting Ceremony, which symbolized the removal of darkness and the spread of knowledge, wisdom, and positive beginnings. This was followed by the Panjab University Anthem, which filled the atmosphere with pride and a strong sense of belonging among the participants.

After the ceremonial proceedings, Dr. Anuj Sharma addressed the gathering and warmly welcomed the chief guests and all the participants, sharing how important it is to keep updating the curriculum in today's fast-changing technological world. He explained that while traditional courses will always have their own value, there is now a strong need to introduce modern curriculum that can prepare students with the right skills for future opportunities and industry expectations.



Following this, Prof. Sonal Chawla also welcomed everyone and expressed her sincere appreciation for the enthusiastic participation from various colleges. She mentioned that workshops like these are very helpful because they bring faculty members together on one platform, where they can openly share ideas, discuss challenges, and work collectively towards meaningful curriculum improvement. She encouraged all participants to actively take part and share their suggestions so that the new courses can be introduced smoothly in a well-planned manner.

The inaugural session was further enriched by the address of Prof. Yojna Rawat, who appreciated this initiative and called it a timely and forward-looking step, highlighting that advanced undergraduate courses will not only strengthen students' knowledge in emerging areas but also make them better prepared for the future. She also emphasized that this workshop was significant because it brought together faculty from different affiliated colleges of Panjab University to share their views and work towards a common academic goal. Her words motivated participants and reinforced the importance of collaborative planning in implementing such new courses successfully. Prof. (Dr.) Meenakshi Goyal also addressed everyone and congratulated the department for taking this meaningful initiative. She appreciated the efforts behind introducing these new-age courses and encouraged everyone to work together so that these courses can be implemented smoothly and benefit students in the best possible way. The session was then graced by the esteemed presence of Prof. (Dr.) Parwinder Singh, who addressed the gathering and shared valuable insights on academic excellence and continuous innovation in higher education. His words encouraged everyone present there to adopt a forward-looking approach towards teaching and learning.

The workshop proceeded with three academic sessions starting at 11:00 AM, during which teams from several colleges affiliated with Panjab University shared their valuable inputs on student needs, syllabus revision, introduction of new undergraduate courses, identifying gaps in the existing curriculum, suggesting improved subject patterns, and exploring practical ways to implement these changes effectively at the college level. The first session was led by Dr. Minakshi Bhardwaj (DAV College, Chandigarh) along with Dr. Sukhdeep Singh (D.M. College, Moga), who shared practical insights from their institutional experiences.

The second session, guided by Dr. Indu Arora and supported by Dr. Ritika Bansal (MCM DAV College for Women, Chandigarh), Mr. Amrinder Singh (Govt. College of Science Education & Research, Jagraon), and Ms. Pawiterjit Kaur (Khalsa College, Garhdiwala), highlighted the importance of modern, skill-based subjects and smooth execution of reforms.